

anonymity. Their identity in the virtual world remains there. In addition, any number of virtual identities are possible and they can operate their criminal activities using any of these virtual identities. This makes the task of identifying the perps extremely difficult for the victims and the investigators.

Significance of cyber crime

Cyber crime has a tremendous impact on the victims and on the judiciary system in general. Since it can easily go undetected and unreported, it's very tough to measure the magnitude of the resulting problems. The number of threats has only increased by leaps and bounds ever since the start of the 21st century. According to recent surveys, the frequency of successful cyber attacks has more than doubled over the past three years, and around 60-65% of citizens worldwide have already been affected by some form of cyber crime. The vast majority of these cases contain elements of fraud and involve financial loss by the victim. The most common targets of cyber criminal activity are found to be government offices and financial institutions. It's a load off our chest though knowing that according to psychologists, the majority of teenage hackers are doing it for the motive of recreation rather than for profit or causing harm.

The aspect of cyber crime that makes it extremely convenient and dangerous is its non-local character – The perpetrator and the victim of the same crime could be separated by a vast distance. This poses several problems when it comes to law enforcement, as the legal implications of the crime could vary in each country. As an example, take the hypothetical case of a person accessing child pornography located on a computer in a country that doesn't ban it. It becomes difficult to determine whether or not he's committing a crime. The problem lies in the undefined location of the source of the crime. The internet offers multiple hiding places in the network and also in the real world. However, cybercriminals leave clues about their identity and location, despite their best efforts to cover their tracks. But, in order to be able to follow up on such clues across national boundaries, there must be treaties of some sort regarding cyber crime between different countries, as the jurisdictions applying to each might differ.

Counter-measures by nations of the world

In 1996, the Council of Europe, together with representatives from the states of Canada, Japan and the United States drafted a preliminary international treaty covering computer crime. There was some rebellion to this though,